

Heritage Fire Watch

Map-based support for heritage fire vulnerability

Albany and Mount Barker region, Western Australia

Audience	Approved users and administrators.
Scope	Account access, map use, site insights, site upload, exports, and administration.
Format	Task-focused steps, reference tables, and troubleshooting guidance.

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1 Purpose and Safe Use

Heritage Fire Watch helps authorised users view fire vulnerability information around cultural heritage sites in the Albany and Mount Barker region of Western Australia. Use it to read the map, inspect sites, upload new site records, and export selected information.

Important use condition

The application is a decision-support tool. It does not replace consultation with Traditional Owners, custodians, land managers, or field verification. Sensitive heritage information must not be misused, redistributed, or made publicly available without permission.

1.1 Who should use this manual

Role	Use this manual for
New user	Creating an account, understanding approval, and learning the main map workflow.
Viewer	Reading the map, opening site details, using site insights, uploading new sites, and exporting map-area records.
Administrator	Approving users, deleting pending accounts, resetting non-admin passwords, and removing uploaded sites.

1.2 The fastest learning path

Ten-minute orientation

1. Open the app and sign in. If you are new, register and wait for administrator approval.
2. Go to **Risk Map**. Leave the default risk layers on.
3. Click a recorded site or uploaded site to read its popup.
4. Turn on **Colour-blind friendly colours** if the default red, amber, and green scale is hard to distinguish.
5. Open **Site Overview** to search and filter all recorded and uploaded sites.
6. Open **Site Insights** from a popup or the overview table to inspect one site in detail.
7. Use **Export** only after panning or zooming the map to the area you want to download.

2 System at a Glance

2.1 Main areas of the application

Area	What it does
Login / Register	Authenticates users and creates pending accounts for administrator approval.
Risk Map	Displays map layers, risk popups, basemaps, colour display options, and export controls.
Site Overview	Lists recorded and uploaded sites with search, source filters, risk filters, and insight links.
Site Insights	Shows site details, risk context, map indicators, and a download for the selected site.
Site Upload	Saves newly identified heritage sites with location, place type, size, notes, and optional photo.
Profile	Shows account details and role information, and provides logout.
Admin	Lets administrators approve pending users, delete pending users, and reset non-admin passwords.
About	Summarises the tool, project partners, use conditions, contact information, and heritage image credits.

3 Accounts and Access

3.1 Create an account

1. Open the application link provided by your organisation or administrator.
2. Select **Register**.
3. Enter Display name, Username, optional Bio, Email, and Password.
4. Use a password with at least 8 characters.
5. Submit the form.

New accounts are created with the **pending** role. A pending user can sign in, but cannot access the main app until an administrator approves the account.

3.2 Sign in and sign out

1. Select **Login**.
2. Enter your email and password.
3. After access is granted, the app opens the main **Risk Map**.
4. To leave the system, open the profile button in the top bar or the account panel and select **Log out**.

3.3 Roles

Role	Permissions
pending	Account exists but is waiting for administrator approval.
viewer	Can access the map, site overview, site insights, site upload, profile, about page, and exports.
admin	Has viewer access plus admin tools for user approval, account deletion, password reset, and uploaded-site removal.

4 Using the Risk Map

4.1 Open the map

After login and approval, the default route opens **Risk Map**. The page has a top navigation bar, a left control sidebar, and the main interactive map.

4.2 Map layers

The map uses these user-facing layers:

Layer	What it shows	When to use it
Recorded Site Priority	Known heritage sites with priority levels.	Start here to review recorded sites.
Precaution Areas	Areas where extra care may be needed.	Use for planning and context.
Uploaded Site Priority	Sites added through Site Upload .	Check new site submissions.
Granite	Granite areas.	Optional background context.
Fire History	Past fire areas.	Optional background context.
Fuel	Fuel patterns.	Optional background context.
Slope	Terrain slope.	Optional terrain context.

4.3 Turn layers on or off

1. Use the **Layers** card in the sidebar.
2. Check a layer to show it.
3. Clear a layer to hide it.
4. Optional layers load only when first switched on, so a short loading state is normal.

4.4 Choose a basemap

Use **Basemap** to switch between:

- **OpenStreetMap**, useful for roads and place context.
- **Google Satellite**, useful for visual ground context.

4.5 Read feature popups

Click a visible feature on the map. Popups are intentionally short so they do not cover the map.

Clicked layer	Typical popup content
Recorded Site Priority	Site name, source, place type, priority level, and a View Site Insights link.
Precaution Areas	Precaution score and precaution level.
Uploaded Site Priority	Site name, place type, priority score, priority level, and a View Site Insights link.
Granite or Fire History	A short subset of available feature properties.

4.6 Risk colours

Default priority colours are green for low, amber for medium, and red for high. Turn on **Colour-blind friendly colours** to use a blue, orange, and pink palette.

Level	Meaning	How to use it
Low	Lower relative priority on the map.	Use as supporting context, not as a reason to ignore local verification.
Medium	Moderate relative priority.	Review site details and map context before deciding next action.
High	Higher relative priority.	Treat as a stronger prompt for review, planning, and consultation.

5 Site Overview

Site Overview is the quickest place to find a site without manually searching the map.

5.1 Search and filter

1. Open **Site Overview** from the top navigation.
2. Search by site name, site ID, or place type.
3. Filter by source, such as **ACHIS Registered**, **ACHIS Lodged**, **Council**, or **Uploaded**.
4. Filter by risk level: low, medium, high, or unknown.

5.2 Open site insights

Select **View insights** for a row. The app opens **Site Insights** with the selected site.

5.3 Admin removal of uploaded sites

Administrators see a **Remove** action for uploaded sites. Recorded heritage sites are not removed through this table.

6 Site Insights

Site Insights provides a focused view of one site. You can reach it from a map popup or from **Site Overview**.

6.1 What the page shows

Depending on available information, the page may show:

- site name, source, place type, and location;
- priority level and supporting risk information;
- fuel, slope, and fire history context where available;
- a small location preview;
- a CSV download for the selected site.

6.2 Export a single site

Use the site export action to download the selected site's information as CSV. The map sidebar export is separate and covers records in the current map area.

7 Uploading a New Site

Site Upload lets authorised users record a newly identified site. The site is stored and then appears through the uploaded-site layer.

7.1 Required fields

Field	Requirement
Site name	Required. The name cannot be blank.
Place type	Required. Choose one value from the list.
Notes	Optional. Use this for short review context.
Reference photo	Optional. JPG, JPEG, PNG, or WEBP, up to 5 MB.
Latitude	Required numeric value from -90 to 90.
Longitude	Required numeric value from -180 to 180.
Site size	Required positive number in metres. The app treats the site as an approximate square of this side length.

7.2 Use current location

Select **Use current location** to ask the browser for your device location. If permission is denied, unavailable, or times out, enter the location manually.

7.3 Study area handling

The supported study area uses these bounds:

- longitude: 117.18 to 118.58;
- latitude: -35.32 to -34.22.

If a submitted site is outside this area, the site is still saved, but risk is not calculated. The page shows a study-area warning.

7.4 After upload

When upload succeeds:

- the site is saved in the system;
- the uploaded-site layer refreshes;

- risk information is added when the site is inside the study area and enough map information is available;
- the optional photo is attached after the site record is created.

8 Exporting Records

Export downloads records intersecting the current visible map bounds.

8.1 Steps

1. Pan or zoom the map to the area you want.
2. In the **Export** card, choose a layer.
3. Choose **CSV** or **Excel (.xlsx)**.
4. Select **Download export**.

8.2 Exportable layers

- Recorded site priority;
- Uploaded sites;
- Precaution zone;
- Granite;
- Fire history.

The downloaded file contains records from the selected layer inside the current map view.

9 Administrator Guide

9.1 Open admin tools

Only users with the **admin** role can open **Admin**.

9.2 Approve or delete pending users

1. Open **Admin**.
2. Use the **Pending users** tab.
3. Select **Approve** to grant viewer access.
4. Select **Delete** to remove a pending account.
5. Use **Refresh** if the page has been open while new registrations arrive.

9.3 Reset a non-admin password

1. Open **Admin**.
2. Switch to **Reset password**.
3. Select **Reset password** for the target non-admin user.
4. Enter a new password with at least 8 characters.

Admin passwords are protected from this page.

9.4 Remove uploaded sites

Administrators can remove uploaded sites from **Site Overview**. Use this for uploaded records that should not remain in the application.

10 Troubleshooting

Problem	What to do
Account is waiting for approval	Ask an administrator to approve your account.
Cannot sign in	Check the email and password. If the problem continues, ask an administrator for help.
Session expired	Sign in again.
Map layer does not appear	Make sure the layer is switched on. Wait briefly, then refresh the page if needed.
Export button is disabled	Pan or zoom the map first so the app can detect the current map area.
Export has no rows	Zoom out, move to the area containing records, or choose another layer.
Site upload is rejected	Check required fields, coordinates, site size, and photo type. Photos must be JPG, PNG, or WEBP and no larger than 5 MB.
Uploaded site has no risk result	The site may be outside the study area or missing enough map information. The site is still saved.
Admin page is unavailable	The account must have the admin role.

11 Glossary

Term	Meaning
ACHIS	Aboriginal Cultural Heritage Inquiry System.
Hazard	Fire-related context from fuel, slope, and fire history.
Precaution zone	Area where local hazard and granite influence suggest extra care may be needed.
Recorded site priority	Risk-priority layer for known heritage sites.
Uploaded site	Site record added by a user.
Vulnerability	Site sensitivity score, mainly based on place type.

12 Version Notes

This manual describes Version 1.0, prepared in May 2026. Ask the project administrator for the latest access details and use conditions.